



photos suitable for casual use. However, colors can appear inconsistent, sometimes looking washed out.

Interestingly, I was surprised by the portraits I captured at night. With proper lighting focused on the subject, the camera delivered good-enough portrait shots even in low-light scenarios. However, it did smooth out the subject. But I must say that I am not impressed by night street shots.

That said, one major drawback is the camera's shutter response. After clicking a picture, you must wait a few seconds before moving the phone, as any immediate movement can result in a blurred image. This can be frustrating for users who need faster, more reliable camera systems.

On the front, there is a 50-megapixel selfie shooter that captures decent details in good lighting. In summary, while the HMD Fusion's camera setup

offers a range of features on paper, its real-world performance is average. The inconsistent color reproduction, low-light limitations, and slow shutter response make it less appealing for users seeking a dependable photography experience.

BATTERY AND CHARGING

The HMD Fusion is equipped with a 5,000mAh battery, which provides enough capacity to last through a full day of moderate use. This battery is supported by 33W fast charging. In my testing, the phone took approximately 111 minutes to charge from 0% to 100%, which is slightly slower than the average for modern smartphones in this segment.

In terms of battery performance, the HMD Fusion holds up well under various usage scenarios. During a 15-minute session of Call of Duty: Mobile, the battery dropped by 5%. GPS navigation for an

hour consumed 5% of the battery, showcasing decent efficiency for a typically demanding task. Streaming YouTube videos for an hour resulted in a 3% drop, highlighting its ability to handle media consumption efficiently.

While the slower charging speed might be a letdown for users who prioritise quick top-ups, the overall battery endurance is reliable.

VERDICT

The HMD Fusion brings an intriguing mix of features to the table, aiming to carve a niche in the budget-smartphone segment. Its retro-inspired design and swappable outfits are standout elements, making it appealing to those who value aesthetics and customisation. However, beneath the stylish exterior, the phone struggles to deliver a truly competitive experience in several key areas.

The display is vibrant indoors but falters under bright sunlight, and the performance is decent for everyday tasks but lags behind similarly priced competitors during demanding activities. The battery life is reliable, though the slow charging speed could be a drawback for users who need quick top-ups. Also, the camera's inconsistent color reproduction and poor low-light performance limit its appeal to photography enthusiasts.

Overall, the HMD Fusion is a phone that prioritises style over substance. It might appeal to casual users who value design and basic functionality, but those seeking a well-rounded device with strong performance and camera capabilities can find better options in the same price range.

—Ayushi Jain

SPECIFICATIONS

Size: 6.56 in (16.66 cm) | Aspect ratio: 20:9 | Features: 90Hz refresh rate, 600 nits peak brightness | Resolution: HD+ (720 x 1612) | Front camera: 50 MP fixed-focus | Rear camera: 108 MP Main Auto Focus with Smart EIS + 2 MP Depth sensor | Rear flash: LED | Battery: 5000 mAh | Battery life: Up to 65h | Charging: 33W charging support (PD & QC) | Wattage: 33 W

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